DATA SCIENTIST & DESIGNER

Azadi Gathui

If it challenges assumptions, connects disciplines, or helps real humans live better,
I'm probably already thinking about it.

gathui@azadi.design LinkedIn GitHub

INDEPENDENT / ACADEMIC

Data Scientist

Zindua School

AUG '25 – PRESENT

Environmental Degradation Monitor

PYTHON / U-NET / TENSORFLOW / SENTINEL-2 / COPERNICUS / STREAMLIT / GEOPANDAS

Trained and evaluated a semantic segmentation model (5.78M parameters) for satellite land-cover classification, and built a complete Streamlit application around it:

- On-demand Sentinel-2 imagery retrieval for protected area shapefiles
- Mask-based change detection on an interactive Streamlit map
- Domain-shift evaluation (India vs Kenya)
- Datasets used:
  - Sentinel-2 imagery
  - World Database on Protected Areas (polygons) by UNEP-WCMC

Geospatial Deep Learning: Land-Cover Classification

PYTHON / CNN / RASTERIO / GEOPANDAS

Built and hyperparameter-tuned a CNN for satellite land-cover classification, and a geospatial pre-processing pipeline to extend it to a real, unlabelled region (Kajiado County, Kenya).

- Datasets used:
  - 'EuroSAT: Land Use and Land Cover Classification with Sentinel-2' by phelber

IUCN Data-Deficient Species Classifier

PYTHON / SCIKIT-LEARN / PANDAS / MACHINE LEARNING / DATA VISUALISATION

Trained a Random Forest classifier predicting IUCN Red List threat status for Kenya's Data-Deficient species (35,000+ records).

- Resources used:
  - Inspired by 'More than half of data deficient species predicted to be threatened by extinction' by Borgelt et al.
  - Spatial data download by IUCN

Kenya Power Pricing Analysis

TABLEAU / SQL / EXCEL

Built an interactive Tableau dashboard exploring electricity pricing, affordability, and the renewable-energy transition, synthesising government tariff schedules, household income data, and regional generation statistics.

FULL-TIME

UX Researcher

Jireh Health

APR ’25 – SEP ’26

Accessible healthcare-financing web app, serving 4 facilities and 1,800+ users.

USER RESEARCH / PROTOTYPING / ACCESSIBILITY / MOBILE UI

Sole designer working from PM-defined acceptance criteria through to engineering handoff.

- Redesigned flows to:
  - cut median signup time from 5.2 to 2.1 mins (-59%).
- Led Jireh Health’s frontend design-system modernisation by:
  - introducing reusable primitives, semantic tokens, and consistent UI patterns
  - improving scalability and maintainability across mobile and web experiences.
- Developed an in-house prototyping tool that:
  - mirrors the deployed frontend
  - decouples UX testing from backend dependencies

FREELANCE

Editorial Designer

UNFCCC High-Level Champions

SEP ’24

ADOBE INDESIGN / EDITORIAL DESIGN

Laid out a position paper for the official champions of the Paris Agreement.

FREELANCE

Branding & Web Designer

KWETU Pride

JUN ’24

FIGMA / DESIGN SYSTEMS

LGBTQ+ professional network for building safer & more inclusive career spaces across the African continent.

FREELANCE

Mobile UI Designer

CarNayo

JUN ’24

Congolese ride-hailing app.

FIGMA / IOS / ANDROID / DESIGN SYSTEMS / USER FLOW MAPPING

- Designed end-to-end UI/UX covering separate driver and passenger journeys.
- Built a design system optimised for low-bandwidth conditions and entry-level Android devices.
- Unified two distinct user mental models, driver and passenger, within a single navigation structure.

FREELANCE

Editorial Designer

inABLE

MAY ’24

ADOBE INDESIGN / ACCESSIBILITY / EDITORIAL DESIGN

Annual accessibility conference in Nairobi.

FREELANCE

Editorial Designer

Children's Investment Fund Foundation (CIFF)

DEC ’23 – FEB ’24

ADOBE INDESIGN / REPORT LAYOUT / EDITORIAL DESIGN

- Designed the official event report for the Children & Youth Pavilion at COP27, commissioned by CIFF.

VOLUNTEER

Comms Team Member

LCOY Kenya

OCT ’22

ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR / BRANDING / EVENT DESIGN

- Rebranded and produced event graphics for YOUNGO's annual Local Conference of Youth on Climate Change in Kenya.

VOLUNTEER

Volunteer

African Youth Conference on Climate Change (AFRIYOCCC)

OCT ’22

ADOBE INDESIGN / EDITORIAL DESIGN

- Designed the attendee resource pack and conference programme for the African Youth Conference on Climate Change.

FULL-TIME

Leja

FEB ’22 – JUN ’25

B2B payments & bookkeeping mobile app serving Kenyan MSMEs and CICO agents.

FIGMA / MUI / ANDROID / PROTOTYPING / USER RESEARCH

Product Designer

NOV ’22 – JUN ’25

- Owned onboarding, referral, and transaction-flow design end-to-end: research, design, developer handoff, and iteration based on usage.
- Designed for a low-bandwidth, non-technical, non-English-dominant user base.
- Partnered directly with developers and product managers to ship designs to real users, then iterated based on usability testing and product feedback.
- Formally led a 2-person design/research team on a dedicated initiative, assigning work and owning outcomes while remaining hands-on in the craft.
- Designed interactive prototypes for partnership presentations and product demos using Figma and the Adobe suite.

- Championed accessibility and usability against W3C/WCAG 2.1 guidelines; produced clear design documentation to ease developer handoff.

Design Associate

FEB – OCT ’22

Graphics and branding: campaign and social ads, merchandise and event stands.

FREELANCE

Branding Designer

Qoba

JAN ’22

ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR / BRAND IDENTITY / SAAS BRANDING

An SME point-of-sale SaaS product.

FREELANCE

Editorial Designer

Society for International Development (SID)

OCT – DEC ’21

ADOBE INDESIGN / COMPLEX LAYOUTS / DATA VISUALISATION

- Laid out a 300-page collaborative research publication for the Kenya Energy Atlas, a joint SID–government initiative.
- Managed complex layouts integrating maps, charts, and long-form academic text across multiple thematic chapters.

FREELANCE

Branding Designer

Belva Homes

JUL ’21

ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR / BRAND IDENTITY / LOGO DESIGN

A luxury residential real estate company in Nairobi.

FREELANCE

Branding Designer

Lizopendwa

MAY – JUN ’21

ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR / BRAND IDENTITY / PRODUCT DESIGN

Kenyan brass jewellery brand.

FULL-TIME

Graphics Designer & Social Media Manager

Herbivore Garden Center

JUN – DEC ’20

ADOBE ILLUSTRATOR / SOCIAL MEDIA DESIGN

Nairobi-based garden centre.

FREELANCE

Editorial Designer

3408 Belva

FEB ’20

ADOBE INDESIGN / EDITORIAL LAYOUT

- Designed a property catalogue for a green-living residential development in Parklands, Nairobi.

VOLUNTEER

Volunteer

Greenpeace Africa – Kenya

ADOBE PHOTOSHOP